

A verb that is combined with an adverb or a preposition, or sometimes both, to give a new meaning, such as 'look after' or 'put somebody off'

1. **ask somebody out**
invite on a date
Brian **asked** Judy **out** to dinner and a movie.
2. **ask around**
ask many people the same question
I **asked around** but nobody has seen my wallet.
3. **add up to something**
equal
Your purchases **add up to** \$205.32.
4. **back something up**
reverse
You'll have to **back up** your car so that I can get out.
5. **back somebody up**
support
My wife **backed** me **up** over my decision to quit my job.
6. **blow up**
explode
The racing car **blew up** after it crashed into the fence.
7. **blow something up**
add air
We have to **blow** 50 balloons **up** for the party.
8. **break down**
stop functioning (vehicle, machine)
Our car **broke down** at the side of the highway in the snowstorm.
9. **break down**
get upset
The woman **broke down** when the police told her that her son had died.
10. **break something down**
divide into smaller parts
Our teacher **broke** the final project **down** into three separate parts.
11. **break in**
force entry to a building
Somebody **broke in** last night and stole our stereo.
12. **break into something**
enter forcibly
The firemen had to **break into** the room to rescue the children.
13. **break something in**
wear something a few times so that it doesn't look/feel new
I need to **break** these shoes **in** before we run next week.
14. **break in**
interrupt
The TV station **broke in** to report the news of the president's death.
15. **break up**
end a relationship
My boyfriend and I **broke up** before I moved to America.
16. **break up**
start laughing (informal)
The kids just **broke up** as soon as the clown started talking.
17. **break out**
escape
The prisoners **broke out** of jail when the guards weren't looking.

18. **break out in something**
develop a skin condition
I **broke out in** a rash after our camping trip.
19. **bring somebody down**
make unhappy
This sad music is **bringing** me **down**.
20. **bring somebody up**
raise a child
My grandparents **brought** me **up** after my parents died.
21. **bring something up**
start talking about a subject
My mother walks out of the room when my father **brings up** sports.
22. **bring something up**
vomit
He drank so much that he **brought** his dinner **up** in the toilet.
23. **call around**
phone many different places/people
We **called around** but we weren't able to find the car part we needed.
24. **call somebody back**
return a phone call
I **called** the company **back** but the offices were closed for the weekend.
25. **call something off**
cancel
Jason **called** the wedding **off** because he wasn't in love with his fiancé.
26. **call on somebody**
ask for an answer or opinion
The professor **called on** me for question 1.
27. **call on somebody**
visit somebody
We **called on** you last night but you weren't home.
28. **call somebody up**
phone
Give me your phone number and I will **call** you **up** when we are in town.
29. **calm down**
relax after being angry
You are still mad. You need to **calm down** before you drive the car.
30. not **care for** somebody/ something
not like (formal)
I don't **care for** his behaviour.
31. **catch up**
get to the same point as somebody else
You'll have to run faster than that if you want to **catch up** with Marty.
32. **check in**
arrive and register at a hotel or airport
We will get the hotel keys when we **check in**.
33. **check out**
leave a hotel
You have to **check out** of the hotel before 11:00 AM.
34. **check somebody/ something out**
look at carefully, investigate
The company **checks out** all new employees.
35. **check out somebody/ something**
look at (informal)
Check out the crazy hair on that guy!

36. **cheer up**
become happier
She **cheered up** when she heard the good news.
37. **cheer somebody up**
make happier
I brought you some flowers to **cheer you up**.
38. **chip in**
help
If everyone **chips in** we can get the kitchen painted by noon.
39. **clean something up**
tidy, clean
Please **clean up** your bedroom before you go outside.
40. **come across something**
find unexpectedly
I **came across** these old photos when I was tidying the closet.
41. **come apart**
separate
The top and bottom **come apart** if you pull hard enough.
42. **come down with something**
become sick
My nephew **came down with** chicken pox this weekend.
43. **come forward**
volunteer for a task or to give evidence
The woman **came forward** with her husband's finger prints.
44. **come from** some place
originate in
The art of origami **comes from** Asia.
45. **count on somebody/ something**
rely on
I am **counting on** you to make dinner while I am out.
46. **cross something out**
draw a line through
Please **cross out** your old address and write your new one.
47. **cut back on something**
consume less
My doctor wants me to **cut back on** sweets and fatty foods.
48. **cut something down**
make something fall to the ground
We had to **cut** the old tree in our yard **down** after the storm.
49. **cut in**
interrupt
Your father **cut in** while I was dancing with your uncle.
50. **cut in**
pull in too closely in front of another vehicle
The bus driver got angry when that car **cut in**.
51. **cut in**
start operating (of an engine or electrical device)
The air conditioner **cuts in** when the temperature gets to 22°C.
52. **cut something off**
remove with something sharp
The doctors **cut off** his leg because it was severely injured.
53. **cut something off**
stop providing
The phone company **cut off** our phone because we didn't pay the bill.

54. **cut somebody off**
take out of a will
My grandparents **cut** my father **off** when he remarried.
55. **cut something out**
remove part of something (usually with scissors and paper)
I **cut** this ad **out** of the newspaper.
56. **do somebody/ something over**
beat up, ransack (BrE, informal)
He's lucky to be alive. His shop was **done over** by a street gang.
57. **do something over**
do again (AmE)
My teacher wants me to **do** my essay **over** because she doesn't like my topic.
58. **do away with something**
discard
It's time to **do away with** all of these old tax records.
59. **do something up**
fasten, close
Do your coat **up** before you go outside. It's snowing!
60. **dress up**
wear nice clothing
It's a fancy restaurant so we have to **dress up**.
61. **drop back**
move back in a position/group
Andrea **dropped back** to third place when she fell off her bike.
62. **drop in/ by/ over**
come without an appointment
I might **drop in/by/over** for tea sometime this week.
63. **drop somebody/ something off**
take somebody/ something somewhere and leave them/it there
I have to **drop** my sister **off** at work before I come over.
64. **drop out**
quit a class, school etc
I **dropped out** of Science because it was too difficult.
65. **eat out**
eat at a restaurant
I don't feel like cooking tonight. Let's **eat out**.
66. **end up**
eventually reach/do/decide
We **ended up** renting a movie instead of going to the theatre.
67. **fall apart**
break into pieces
My new dress **fell apart** in the washing machine.
68. **fall down**
fall to the ground
The picture that you hung up last night **fell down** this morning.
69. **fall out**
separate from an interior
The money must have **fallen out** of my pocket.
70. **fall out**
(of hair, teeth) become loose and unattached
His hair started to **fall out** when he was only 35.
71. **figure something out**
understand, find the answer
I need to **figure out** how to fit the piano and the bookshelf in this room.

72. **fill something in**
to write information in blanks, as on a form (BrE)
Please **fill in** the form with your name, address, and phone number.
73. **fill something out**
to write information in blanks, as on a form (AmE)
The form must be **filled out** in capital letters.
74. **fill something up**
fill to the top
I always **fill** the water jug **up** when it is empty.
75. **find out**
discover
We don't know where he lives. How can we **find out**?
76. **find something out**
discover
We tried to keep the time of the party a secret, but Samantha **found it out**.
77. **get something across/ over**
communicate, make understandable
I tried to **get** my point **across/over** to the judge but she wouldn't listen.
78. **get along/on**
like each other
I was surprised how well my new girlfriend and my sister **got along/on**.
79. **get around**
have mobility
My grandfather can **get around** fine in his new wheelchair.
80. **get away**
go on a vacation
We worked so hard this year that we had to **get away** for a week.
81. **get away with something**
do without being noticed or punished
Jason always **gets away with** cheating in his maths tests.
82. **get back**
return
We **got back** from our vacation last week.
83. **get something back**
receive something you had before
Liz finally **got** her Science notes **back** from my room-mate.
84. **get back at somebody**
retaliate, take revenge
My sister **got back at** me for stealing her shoes. She stole my favourite hat.
85. **get back into something**
become interested in something again
I finally **got back into** my novel and finished it.
86. **get on something**
step onto a vehicle
We're going to freeze out here if you don't let us **get on** the bus.
87. **get over something**
recover from an illness, loss, difficulty
I just **got over** the flu and now my sister has it.
88. **get over something**
overcome a problem
The company will have to close if it can't **get over** the new regulations.
89. **get round to something**
finally find time to do (AmE: **get around to something**)
I don't know when I am going to **get round to** writing the thank you cards.

90. **get together**
meet (usually for social reasons)
Let's **get together** for a BBQ this weekend.
91. **get up**
get out of bed
I **got up** early today to study for my exam.
92. **get up**
stand
You should **get up** and give the elderly man your seat.
93. **give somebody away**
reveal hidden information about somebody
His wife **gave** him **away** to the police.
94. **give somebody away**
take the bride to the altar
My father **gave** me **away** at my wedding.
95. **give something away**
ruin a secret
My little sister **gave** the surprise party **away** by accident.
96. **give something away**
give something to somebody for free
The library was **giving away** old books on Friday.
97. **give something back**
return a borrowed item
I have to **give** these skates **back** to Franz before his hockey game.
98. **give in**
reluctantly stop fighting or arguing
My boyfriend didn't want to go to the ballet, but he finally **gave in**.
99. **give something out**
give to many people (usually at no cost)
They were **giving out** free perfume samples at the department store.
100. **give something up**
quit a habit
I am **giving up** smoking as of January 1st.
101. **give up**
stop trying
My maths homework was too difficult so I **gave up**.
102. **go after somebody**
follow somebody
My brother tried to **go after** the thief in his car.
103. **go after something**
try to achieve something
I **went after** my dream and now I am a published writer.
104. **go against somebody**
compete, oppose
We are **going against** the best soccer team in the city tonight.
105. **go ahead**
start, proceed
Please **go ahead** and eat before the food gets cold.
106. **go back**
return to a place
I have to **go back** home and get my lunch.
107. **go out**
leave home to go on a social event
We're **going out** for dinner tonight.

108. **go out with somebody**
date
Jesse has been **going out with** Luke since they met last winter.
109. **go over something**
review
Please **go over** your answers before you submit your test.
110. **go over**
visit somebody nearby
I haven't seen Tina for a long time. I think I'll **go over** for an hour or two.
111. **go without something**
suffer lack or deprivation
When I was young, we **went without** winter boots.
112. **grow apart**
stop being friends over time
My best friend and I **grew apart** after she changed schools.
113. **grow back**
regrow
My roses **grew back** this summer.
114. **grow into something**
grow big enough to fit
This bike is too big for him now, but he should **grow into** it by next year.
115. **grow out of something**
get too big for
Elizabeth needs a new pair of shoes because she has **grown out of** her old ones.
116. **grow up**
become an adult
When Jack **grows up** he wants to be a fireman.
117. **hand something down**
give something used to somebody else
I **handed** my old comic books **down** to my little cousin.
118. **hand something in**
submit
I have to **hand in** my essay by Friday.
119. **hand something out**
to distribute to a group of people
We will **hand out** the invitations at the door.
120. **hand something over**
give (usually unwillingly)
The police asked the man to **hand over** his wallet and his weapons.
121. **hang in**
stay positive (informal)
Hang in there. I'm sure you'll find a job very soon.
122. **hang on**
wait a short time (informal)
Hang on while I grab my coat and shoes!
123. **hang out**
spend time relaxing (informal)
Instead of going to the party we are just going to **hang out** at my place.
124. **hang up**
end a phone call
He didn't say goodbye before he **hung up**.
125. **hold somebody/ something back**
prevent from doing/going
I had to **hold** my dog **back** because there was a cat in the park.

126. **hold something back**
hide an emotion
Jamie **held back** his tears at his grandfather's funeral.
127. **hold on**
wait a short time
Please **hold on** while I transfer you to the Sales Department.
128. **hold onto somebody/ something**
hold firmly using your hands or arms
Hold onto your hat because it's very windy outside.
129. **hold somebody/ something up**
rob
A man in a black mask **held** the bank **up** this morning.
130. **keep on doing something**
continue doing
Keep on stirring until the liquid comes to a boil.
131. **keep something from somebody**
not tell
We **kept** our relationship **from** our parents for two years.
132. **keep somebody/ something out**
stop from entering
Try to **keep** the wet dog **out** of the living room.
133. **keep something up**
continue at the same rate
If you **keep** those results **up** you will get into a great college.
134. **let somebody down**
fail to support or help, disappoint
I need you to be on time. Don't **let** me **down** this time.
135. **let somebody in**
allow to enter
Can you **let** the cat **in** before you go to school?
136. **log in (or on)**
sign in (to a website, database etc)
I can't **log in** to Facebook because I've forgotten my password.
137. **log out (or off)**
sign out (of a website, database etc)
If you don't **log off** somebody could get into your account.
138. **look after somebody/ something**
take care of
I have to **look after** my sick grandmother.
139. **look down on somebody**
think less of, consider inferior
Ever since we stole that chocolate bar your dad has **looked down on** me.
140. **look for somebody/ something**
try to find
I'm **looking for** a red dress for the wedding.
141. **look forward to something**
be excited about the future
I'm **looking forward to** the Christmas break.
142. **look into something**
investigate
We are going to **look into** the price of snowboards today.
143. **look out**
be careful, vigilant, and take notice
Look out! That car's going to hit you!

144. **look out for somebody/ something**
be especially vigilant for
Don't forget to **look out for** snakes on the hiking trail.
145. **look something over**
check, examine
Can you **look over** my essay for spelling mistakes?
146. **look something up**
search and find information in a reference book or database
We can **look** her phone number **up** on the Internet.
147. **look up to somebody**
have a lot of respect for
My little sister has always **looked up** to me.
148. **make something up**
invent, lie about something
Josie **made up** a story about why we were late.
149. **make up**
forgive each other
We were angry last night, but we **made up** at breakfast.
150. **make somebody up**
apply cosmetics to
My sisters **made me up** for my graduation party.
151. **mix something up**
confuse two or more things
I **mixed up** the twins' names again!
152. **pass away**
die
His uncle **passed away** last night after a long illness.
153. **pass out**
faint
It was so hot in the church that an elderly lady **passed out**.
154. **pass something out**
give the same thing to many people
The professor **passed** the textbooks **out** before class.
155. **pass something up**
decline (usually something good)
I **passed up** the job because I am afraid of change.
156. **pay somebody back**
return owed money
Thanks for buying my ticket. I'll **pay** you **back** on Friday.
157. **pay for something**
be punished for doing something bad
That bully will **pay for** being mean to my little brother.
158. **pick something out**
choose
I **picked out** three sweaters for you to try on.
159. **point somebody/ something out**
indicate with your finger
I'll **point** my boyfriend **out** when he runs by.
160. **put something down**
put what you are holding on a surface or floor
You can **put** the groceries **down** on the kitchen counter.
161. **put somebody down**
insult, make somebody feel stupid
The students **put** the substitute teacher **down** because his pants were too short.

162. **put something off**
postpone
We are **putting off** our trip until January because of the hurricane.
163. **put something out**
extinguish
The neighbours **put** the fire **out** before the firemen arrived.
164. **put something together**
assemble
I have to **put** the crib **together** before the baby arrives.
165. **put up with somebody/ something**
tolerate
I don't think I can **put up with** three small children in the car.
166. **put something on**
put clothing/ accessories on your body
Don't forget to **put on** your new earrings for the party.
167. **run into somebody/ something**
meet unexpectedly
I **ran into** an old school-friend at the mall.
168. **run over somebody/ something**
drive a vehicle over a person or thing
I accidentally **ran over** your bicycle in the driveway.
169. **run over/ through something**
rehearse, review
Let's **run over/through** these lines one more time before the show.
170. **run away**
leave unexpectedly, escape
The child **ran away** from home and has been missing for three days.
171. **run out**
have none left
We **ran out** of shampoo so I had to wash my hair with soap.
172. **send something back**
return (usually by mail)
My letter got **sent back** to me because I used the wrong stamp.
173. **set something up**
arrange, organize
Our boss **set** a meeting **up** with the president of the company.
174. **set somebody up**
trick, trap
The police **set up** the car thief by using a hidden camera.
175. **shop around**
compare prices
I want to **shop around** a little before I decide on these boots.
176. **show off**
act extra special for people watching (usually boastfully)
He always **shows off** on his skateboard
177. **sleep over**
stay somewhere for the night (informal)
You should **sleep over** tonight if the weather is too bad to drive home.
178. **sort something out**
organize, resolve a problem
We need to **sort** the bills **out** before the first of the month.
179. **stick to something**
continue doing something, limit yourself to one particular thing
You will lose weight if you **stick to** the diet.

180. **switch something off**
stop the energy flow, turn off
The light's too bright. Could you **switch** it **off**.
181. **switch something on**
start the energy flow, turn on
We heard the news as soon as we **switched on** the car radio.
182. **take after somebody**
resemble a family member
I **take after** my mother. We are both impatient.
183. **take something apart**
purposely break into pieces
He **took** the car brakes **apart** and found the problem.
184. **take something back**
return an item
I have to **take** our new TV **back** because it doesn't work.
185. **take off**
start to fly
My plane **takes off** in five minutes.
186. **take something off**
remove something (usually clothing)
Take off your socks and shoes and come in the lake!
187. **take something out**
remove from a place or thing
Can you **take** the garbage **out** to the street for me?
188. **take somebody out**
pay for somebody to go somewhere with you
My grandparents **took** us **out** for dinner and a movie.
189. **tear something up**
rip into pieces
I **tore up** my ex-boyfriend's letters and gave them back to him.
190. **think back**
remember (often + to, sometimes + on)
When I **think back** on my youth, I wish I had studied harder.
191. **think something over**
consider
I'll have to **think** this job offer **over** before I make my final decision.
192. **throw something away**
dispose of
We **threw** our old furniture **away** when we won the lottery.
193. **turn something down**
decrease the volume or strength (heat, light etc)
Please **turn** the TV **down** while the guests are here.
194. **turn something down**
refuse
I **turned** the job **down** because I don't want to move.
195. **turn something off**
stop the energy flow, switch off
Your mother wants you to **turn** the TV **off** and come for dinner.
196. **turn something on**
start the energy, switch on
It's too dark in here. Let's **turn** some lights **on**.
197. **turn something up**
increase the volume or strength (heat, light etc)
Can you **turn** the music **up**? This is my favourite song.

198. **turn up**
appear suddenly
Our cat **turned up** after we put posters up all over the neighbourhood.
199. **try something on**
sample clothing
I'm going to **try** these jeans **on**, but I don't think they will fit.
200. **try something out**
test
I am going to **try** this new brand of detergent **out**.
201. **use something up**
finish the supply
The kids **used** all of the toothpaste **up** so we need to buy some more.
202. **wake up**
stop sleeping
We have to **wake up** early for work on Monday.
203. **warm somebody/ something up**
increase the temperature
You can **warm** your feet **up** in front of the fireplace.
204. **warm up**
prepare body for exercise
I always **warm up** by doing sit-ups before I go for a run.
205. **wear off**
fade away
Most of my make-up **wore off** before I got to the party.
206. **work out**
exercise
I **work out** at the gym three times a week.
207. **work out**
be successful
Our plan **worked out** fine.
208. **work something out**
make a calculation
We have to **work out** the total cost before we buy the house.